

The Woman
Who Became
Epstein's Heir

Dentist May Receive as
Much as \$100 Million

By MATTHEW GOLDSTEIN and SHARON OTTERMAN

The young dentist was smiling and soft-spoken, wearing a Columbia University fleece jacket and holding her long hair back with a clip. She was introduced by her assistant simply as “Dr. Karyna.”

But what the patient — who had come to the office in December expecting to see a different dentist — didn't know was that she was being treated by Dr. Karyna Shuliak, the notorious sex offender Jeffrey Epstein's girlfriend.

Dr. Shuliak was the last person Mr. Epstein called before he killed himself in his jail cell in 2019. She could inherit as much as \$100 million from his estate, including a 33-carat diamond ring, according to a trove of investigative records released by federal authorities.

But on that winter day, Dr. Shuliak was working as a part-time dentist in an unremarkable office in Downtown Brooklyn, according to dentists who work or used to work at the practice.

Her attempt to forge something of a normal life, though, was soon shattered when the Justice Department released three million pages of investigative files and emails it had gathered on Mr. Epstein. The files, released in late January, included thousands of intimate emails between Dr. Shuliak and Mr. Epstein and dozens of photographs of her and of them together.

Suddenly, their nearly eight-year relationship was on vivid display for all to see. They had fights about sex — with both wanting more at different times. She placed orders to a sexual wellness company for couples. She periodically sent him links to graphic pornographic videos. In some emails they discussed birth control.

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Stockpile Fears
Defer Attacks
Against Iran

By ERIC SCHMITT and JONATHAN SWAN

President Trump has set aside, at least for now, plans to sharply escalate the American military assault against Iran, with particular concern that intensifying the war could dangerously drain the Pentagon's already diminished stockpile of Patriot antimissile interceptors and other air defense munitions in the Middle East.

The threat to interceptor stockpiles is one of many considerations that have made a return to major combat operations a hugely risky endeavor, administration officials say. Mr. Trump and his top aides are also uneasy about the prospect of a widening war in the Middle East, the alienation of key Gulf allies who are vulnerable to Iranian attack, a global economic crunch, and growing energy and refugee crises.

The latest turn in Mr. Trump's handling of the conflict with Iran came after a meeting on Friday with top advisers and senior members of his cabinet, according to two people briefed on the discussion.

The private deliberations have focused on the Pentagon's shrinking inventory of Patriot interceptors and other air defenses, the officials said, discussing operational matters on the condition of anonymity. Three U.S. soldiers in Jordan were killed last Friday when a ballistic missile slipped through American air defenses fending off

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A model of the new Air Force One in the Oval Office in October. The Qatari-donated 747-8 plane was overhauled in just about eight months, not the several years experts said would be needed.

Iran War Leaves Farmers Desperate for Diesel

By PETER S. GOODMAN

RAJSHAHI, Bangladesh — For three days, he waited at the gas station in a crush of hundreds of villagers, as the temperature rose to 104 degrees. People tried to cut the line, and fights broke out, drawing police officers wielding batons. This, Dulal Hossain endured for the chance to buy diesel fuel.

He was tormented by worries about his rice plants, the source of most of his livelihood. The diesel he eventually carried home by bicycle, in a jerrycan strung from the handlebars, would fuel the pump that bathed his fields with groundwater. The pump was empty.

It was late March, the dry season in western Bangladesh, and a month after the United States and Israel unleashed war on Iran. Around the globe, energy prices were soaring as shipping was halted through the Strait of Hormuz. In South Asia, diesel was scarce. So crops were deprived of water.

For six weeks, Mr. Hossain, 68, pedaled between the gas station and his fields, bearing replenishment for his pump. He inspected his rice plants like a parent attending to an afflicted child. Their leaves were turning yellow. Stems drooped toward cracked soil.

He could not stave off calamity. When he harvested his rice last

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Dulal Hossain relies on diesel-powered irrigation pumps to maintain his rice crop. The blockade of the Strait of Hormuz has sent oil prices soaring and has made diesel fuel scarce in Bangladesh.

Inside Trump's Push to Get
New Air Force One Aloft

A Times Investigation Finds Trade-Offs in
Plane Security and Ballooning Costs

This article is by Eric Lipton, Tyler Pager and Maggie Haberman.

WASHINGTON — President Trump was entranced. It was a few weeks into his second term, and he was on the tarmac of the Palm Beach airport, getting a tour of a luxury Boeing 747-8 that had been flown from Doha for his perusal.

The double-decker jet, which had been outfitted for the Qatari royal family, had a spacious bedroom adorned with leather and wood and a lounge featuring a chandelier and another with suede seats.

Two planes being built by Boeing to replace the aging Air Force One fleet were years behind schedule, and Mr. Trump's team had asked the Air Force to find a temporary aircraft. This was the one, the president decided.

Mr. Trump's February 2025 tour of the Qatari jet led to a frantic sprint inside the White House and the Pentagon. The administration sought to upgrade the plane in time to meet his demand for it to be ready by the nation's 250th birthday this summer, with an accelerated retrofit.

An investigation by The New York Times found that the president's push to get the luxury aircraft quickly led to ballooning costs and trade-offs in safety features that potentially left Mr. Trump and others who travel with him on Air Force One vulnerable.

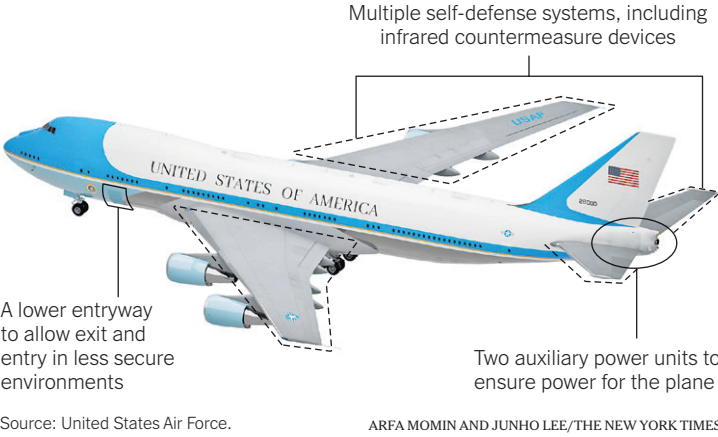
Among the findings:

Mr. Trump was personally engaged in making decisions about the retrofitting of the donated plane, giving the final approval on the features and security measures that would be included, according to people familiar with his role. They and others interviewed for this article described the sensitive information about the process and the plane on the condition of anonymity.

Several key security and safety features on the Boeing planes that have been used for decades as Air Force One are not visible on the upgraded jet, including a lower-

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Some Security Features on the Old Air Force One



RIISING WEALTH The president's business ventures have expanded in areas in which he wields great influence, like cryptocurrency. PAGE 14

Even 'Salad Queen' Says Nope
To Greens as Outbreak Grows

By JULIE CRESWELL

Sara Tercero loves salads. She goes through two plastic containers of salad — mostly kale — each week. A food influencer, she posts her favorite salad recipes on her website. She plans to release a cookbook next year, titled “Salad Queen.”

But as the number of cyclospora infections tied to lettuce has soared to a record high, Ms. Tercero has broken up with all leafy greens.

“I went grocery shopping yesterday and stared at all of the lettuce in the clam packages. None of it was touched,” Ms. Tercero said. “I'm avoiding buying all of it in the grocery store right now.”

Federal health officials have confirmed or are investigating more than 11,500 cases of cyclosporiasis in 41 states, with many people becoming ill with stomach cramps and severe diarrhea. Authorities said they had linked some of the cases to iceberg lettuce grown in Mexico and served at some Taco Bell locations. That led Taylor Farms, the country's largest produce supplier, to voluntarily recall lettuce shipped to 27 states.

None of that has calmed the country, which is in the grip of the Great Lettuce Scare.

The illnesses and uncertainty have caused many consumers to leave containers of raw spinach, arugula and romaine on many grocery store shelves and to steer clear of leafy greens in restaurants.

“Our lettuce sales are probably off about 10 or 11 percent,” said Stew Leonard Jr., the president and chief executive of Stew Leonard's, a grocer with locations in New York, New Jersey and Connecticut. He said the family-owned chain did not get any lettuce from Taylor Farms, adding that all of its lettuce comes from Canada and California.

“We definitely can see there is a percentage of customers out there saying, ‘I'm not going to buy any lettuce right now, period,’” he said. “They are listening to the news, and, for them, lettuce is practically radioactive.”

Visits to salad-centric restaurant chains like Sweetgreen, Chopt, Chipotle, Cava and Panera

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Consumers have been confused by mixed messages.

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The case of a teenager who did not return from a trip with his white friends has stirred anguish and outrage. PAGE 19

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Billionaire-funded PACs are rallying around the Maine senator. Democrats have a lot of catching up to do. PAGE 22

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The Amaurys of Paris own the race, and the family won't share the \$170 million in media revenue. PAGE 1



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The island nation is testing ways to maintain vital supplies if China one day imposes a maritime siege. PAGE 4

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While Coach Nick Sirianni comes up with creative ways to reach players in his sixth year, he enters yet another season under scrutiny. PAGE 27

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Charles Ross spent 50 years building “Star Axis” in New Mexico. PAGE 10

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A Chic Market in Manhattan
Sammy Nussdorf found his calling in the gourmet store Meadow Lane. PAGE 8



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Expectations were high, but did the visiting soccer fans deliver a hoped-for boon to the local economy? PAGE 1

Putting Brooklyn on Display
Michael McLeer is inspired to honor the area's music, films and neighborhoods by way of his many exhibits. PAGE 6

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